

You. Me. Her. Fish. Uncle.

By Rhea Madhogarhia and Camille Cypher

Characters:

Gabriel:

- Johnson Quail
 - Learning self-love.
 - Lonely, a little awkward, not socially, just doesn't think people generally want to be around him
 - Moments of hidden happiness by the craziness of the restaurant are encouraged

Daniel: Person A (always exits stage left. All props on stage left.)

- Maitre D':
 - *Always has a towel over arm*
 - sympathetic and a little dumb
- Dave:
 - *Cowboy hat or flannel*
 - Drunk, southerner
- Selen De On:
 - *Scarf over shoulders or sunglasses*
 - Gaudy, diva, outrageous, traveled woman, with unbelievable stories that are completely true
- FISH with breasts:
 - *A bra over shirt and a button up*
 - maybe a figment of imagination, who knows, probably what Johnson wants to hear
- Person A:
 - *Mic: either karaoke fake mic (rhea has) or banana*
 - Just has to sing "home of the brave"—can be very bad

Avery: Person B (Always exits stage right. All props stage right.)

- Waiter:
 - *Black vest*
 - aims to please. Think Kenneth from 30 Rock.
- Bartender:
 - *Baseball cap*
 - sympathetic but able to switch into a big tough guy who can throw out rowdy barflies
- Chef:
 - *Chef's hat (or one made of paper or stick on mustache)*
 - "New york accent," loud, he cares.
- Hibachi Chef:

- *Chef's hat and forks/spatulas*
- very into his job as a hibachi chef, crazy physicality
- Marilyn Monroe:
 - *Smearred red lipstick*
 - sultry, overacting, kisses
- Tap dancer (Angelina):
 - *Socks, always doing jazz hands*
 - tap dances in socks

PROPS (with which character has to be responsible for them):

STAGE LEFT

- Maitre D':
 - towel
 - Clipboard (for reservation checking)
 - Menus
 - Buttered pasta plate
- Jeremy:
 - Flannel or cowboy hat
- Selen De On:
 - Scarf
 - sunglasses
- FISH with breasts:
 - Bra
 - Overshirt (like a button up)
- PERSON A:
 - Mic
 - Melodica

STAGE RIGHT

- Waiter:
 - Black vest
 - Bottle of Water and Glass for JOHNSON
 - Glass with chardonnay (water) for SELEN
 - Caviar dish
- Bartender
 - Baseball cap
 - Waterbottle to shake (placed at bar)
 - Waterbottle for gin (placed at bar)
- Chef
 - Chef's hat
 - Ladle for gesturing

- Hibachi Chef
 - Chef's hat
 - Spatulas or forks
- Marilyn Monroe
 - Red lipstick
- Tap dancer
 - socks

LIGHTS UP

A restaurant—Carols and Cavs. Two tables are set up with one chair behind each. One table is center stage. The other is just a bit stage left. There is a bar (two acting blocks stacked on top of each other, upstage right, facing stage left)

JOHNSON QUAIL enters down stage right. He is greeted by MAITRE' D (A).

MAITRE' D (A): Good afternoon, sir. Welcome to Carols & Cavs. Is this your first time dining with us?

JOHNSON: Yes. Thank you so much. I called in with a reservation for one? Last name Quail?

MAITRE' D (A): Ah yes. Here it is. Right this way.

They walk to the centerstage table. JOHNSON sits.

MAITRE' D (A): So, just you tonight? Are we celebrating anything?

JOHNSON: Just me. No special occasion. Just don't get a lot of time to myself, so I thought I'd take myself out!

MAITRE' D (A): *More performative and energetic.* Ah yes, we get a lot of you in January. Resolutions and all.... *In a more consoling, hushed tone.* You'll meet someone soon, I'm sure.

JOHNSON: No, no... I'm not looking for anyone right now. Just me.

MAITRE' D (A): *Genuine.* Of course, sir. Someone will be by shortly with some water. Do you prefer tap or sparkling?

JOHNSON: Oh... um, sparkling sounds nice.

MAITRE' D (A) smiles warmly at JOHNSON and exits stage left. A beat for JOHNSON to look around, tap his feet, and end staring at the table. WAITER (B) walks in stage right with a bottle of water and a glass.

WAITER (B): Your water, Mr. Quail.

JOHNSON: How did you know my name?

WAITER (B): Just something we like to know.

JOHNSON is a little confused but is slightly smiling. He likes that people know his name here.

WAITER (B): Oh, I'm so sorry Mr. Quail, I seem to have forgotten your menus! Silly me... I'll be back.

WAITER (B) exits stage right. MAITRE' D (A) reenters with menu stage left.

MAITRE' D (A): Here are your menus.

JOHNSON: Oh I thought— *pointing upstage right.*

MAITRE' D (A): No, no. He knows I've got them. *Smiling.*

JOHNSON: uh- *struggling for words looking back and forth between upstage right and at MAITRE' D(A)*

MAITRE' D (A): *Clears throat.* I'll give you a moment to look at the menu, but just so you know we have a wonderful bar here. You'll have to go up there to order. Matt is working tonight, so you're in good hands. We're best buds.

JOHNSON: Oh.. Oh, that's sweet

MAITRE' D (A): Yeah, we like to be a family around here.

JOHNSON: Aw.

MAITRE' D (A): Yeah... Are you close with your family, Mr. Quail?

They sit in it for an awkward moment.

JOHNSON: Umm.... So bar... Um, bar yeah.

MAITRE' D (A): Bar, yes. I'll leave you to it.

MAITRE' D (A) exits stage left. JOHNSON shakes himself off as if thinking about his family but stands, slightly flustered, and approaches the bar. BARTENDER (B) springs up—exaggeratedly so—from behind the bar. BARTENDER (B) begins and does not stop comically shaking a glass or something (can be a waterbottle).

BARTENDER (B): Good evening, sir! What'll it be tonight? Gin and tonic? You look like a gin and tonic kind of guy.

JOHNSON: Uh, yeah, actually. That's kinda the only thing I drink.

BARTENDER (B): Yeah, not a fan of gin myself, but you look like you'd be a fan of Rustic Cavern. You know, the one brewed on 54th and Lairmont.

JOHNSON: Wait, that was my dad's favorite gin. The one in the [insert color of bottle] bottle, right?

BARTENDER (B). Yup, got it right here.

JOHNSON: That's kinda the only reason I drink it... my dad...not actually that much of a fan of alcohol. I kinda just order drinks because—

BARTENDER (B). —You think it'll make you seem like more of an adult.

JOHNSON: Yeah—

DAVE (A) enters stage left. He is drunk and southern, stumbling around the stage.

BARTENDER (B): Hey! Dave! What did I tell you about coming back in here?!

DAVE (A): Matt, it's fine!! Look, I'm hardly drunk.

BARTENDER (B): Don't make me throw you out of here again.

DAVE (A): Try me!

BARTENDER (B): *to JOHNSON.* Give me a second.

BARTENDER (B) rushes around the bar. DAVE (A) and BARTENDER (B) proceed to have a fight scene.

They tussle. DAVE (A) gets slapped. Both end up off stage right. DAVE (A) is thrown back in to the stage. He runs back off stage left. He is thrown out again into the middle of the stage. Where he lays unconscious.

BARTENDER (B) reenters.

BARTENDER (B). Whoo! Sorry about that! Here's a drink for the road.

JOHNSON: I'm not ... going anywhere.

BARTENDER (B) leaves very chipper without further explanation. JOHNSON returns to his table with his drink. At the same time, DAVE (A) regains consciousness, brushes himself off, very professionally, takes off hat or flannel, gets a towel from pocket and puts it over his arm, turning into the MAITRE' D (A).

JOHNSON: Well, that was weird.

MAITRE' D (A) pops up right behind him.

MAITRE' D (A): See anything you like?

JOHNSON: HOLY SHIT. Sorry, you scared me.

MAITRE' D (A): No worries! Did you get a chance to look at our caviar offerings? It's our namesake.

JOHNSON: Oh.. cav is short for caviar?

MAITRE' D (A): You're silly, Mr. Quail. Of course it is! Our caviar is straight from the fish's breast.

JOHNSON: I don't think that's where it comes out.

MAITRE' D (A): *Genuine.* Oh? Mr. Quail, are you a chef?

JOHNSON: No. I just know that caviar doesn't come out of the breast.

CHEF (B) pops out stage right. Heavy New York Accent.

CHEF (B): Hey. You don't know what the fuck we use here. We got a special type of fish with big ol' lady breasts where we get the caviar. So fuck you.

CHEF (B) exits stage right.

JOHNSON: Oh I'm sorry I didn't mean to upset him.

MAITRE' D (A): Eh, don't worry. It comes from a place of love. Just the other day he called Angelina a whore for her doing her gig without tap shoes on.

CHEF(B) sticks his head out of stage right.

CHEF (B): I didn't call her a whore. I just said she didn't make no noise. She's a tap dancer with no tap shoes.

MAITRE' D (A): Yeah, but she doesn't have the money for tap shoes right now. I mean we all work for free at a No-Michelen Star restaurant.

CHEF (B): AAH. You're right. You're right. She's a talented lady. Somebody's got to get her some shoes. She could be the next Patti LuPone.

CHEF (B) leaves stage right.

MAITRE' D (A): It looks like you need some more time. I'll be back.

MAITRE' D (A) pats him on the shoulder and leaves stage left.

A beat.

JOHNSON: This sure is an eccentric place. Oh I've got to tell—*Goes to pick up phone. He decides against it. Nevermind. Puts phone away. Starts looking at menu.*

WAITER (B) enters stage right. Pops up right behind JOHNSON, startling him again.

WAITER (B): Have you made a decision???

JOHNSON: JEEZ!

WAITER (B): Ohhhh. The cheese. The fried cheese. Excellent choice, Mr. Quail.

JOHNSON: Oh... no.. Um... *embarrassed*. Do you have buttered pasta?

WAITER (B): *Loud. Unaware of JOHNSON's embarrassment* Oh! From our kid's menu!

JOHNSON: *Really wanting WAITER (B) to be quieter* Yes... But could you make it an adult portion?

WAITER (B): Absolutely, Mr. Quail. You'd be surprised how many closed-off, damaged, frail... short men order that. Very used to the portion change.

JOHNSON: *Feigning extreme masculinity*. You know what, I'll get the ribs, the whole plate. Make sure it's from a female cow. I'm a man's man.

WAITER (B): I understand, Mr. Quail.

SELEN (A) enters stage left. She is rich and gaudy. She knows what she wants. She sits at the table stage left.

WAITER (B): Oh, Ms. De On. A pleasure to see you. The soup as usual? And a glass of chardonnay?

SELEN (A): Ooooooh, you know me so well. Hey, how's the fish?

WAITER (B): Oh! She's doing quite well, she'll be happy to hear you asked about her.

JOHNSON: What??

SELEN (A): Give her my best regards.

WAITER (B): Will do. I'll get those orders in for you both.

SELEN (A): Tata. *twinkles her fingers*.

WAITER (B) leaves stage right.

SELEN (A): You look like a delicious piece of meat.

JOHNSON: Oh. *Looks around*. You're talking to me?

SELEN (A): *Gaudy as hell*. Why of course, dear. Now tell me. Say, do you like to travel?

JOHNSON: *Gesturing to the restaurant around him.* Eh, this is as much as I get out.

SELEN (A): How tragic... Let me tell you about my travels. Have you heard of Paris? It's french.

JOHNSON: Yes?

SELEN (A): Surprising. Do you know Liza Minelli? Well, *I* call her *Lezbo* Minnelli.

JOHNSON: That seems kind of offensive.

SELEN (A): She's gay.

JOHNSON: How do you know that?

SELEN: Oh well you know. France. French. Frenching. In my Villa. Her. Me. Me kissing her. Her kissing me. On the lips. The lower ones. Sensual. Senses. She orgasms. I don't. I ask her to stay. I leave. *More normal.* Anyways, it didn't work out.

JOHNSON: Woah. That's kind of crazy.

SELEN (A): You haven't heard my story about Clinton. Hillary Clinton. I call her Hilary Clitoris. Her. Me—

JOHNSON: Oh you don't have to get into that again. I think I understand.

WAITER (B) enters stage right. He has placed a plate in front of JOHNSON.

WAITER (B): I'm so sorry to interrupt, but Ms. De On, we're all out of the soup. But here's your champagne.

SELEN takes a sip of her champagne and does a spit take into JOHNSON's face.

SELEN (A): All out of soup? This is worse than my date with Neil Patrick Harris. I know him as Nipple Penis Hairy. That's right. We both swing both ways. Him. Me. A third person.

WAITR (B) pushes her off stage slowly as she continues.

SELEN (A): Sexing. Smurfing. He dies. I resurrect him. Anderson Cooper appears.

SELEN is fully offstage.

WAITER(B): I'm so sorry about her. She does this every time she's here.

SELEN (A): *Offstage.* CUNNULINGUS.

WAITER (B): I brought you a little something.... *Motions to table where caviar is.* Some caviar, on the house.

JOHNSON: Oh. *Smells the caviar and gags.* You really didn't have to do that.

WAITER (B): Just try it. You can trust me.

WAITER (B) smiles at JOHNSON and exits stage right.

FISH (A) ENTERS stage left, wearing a jacket.

JOHNSON: Oh my god. Are you—

FISH (A): That's right. I'm *the* fish. WITH BREASTS. *Rips outer layer off to show bra over shirt.*

JOHNSON: *Blinking and squinting.* Is this real?

FISH (A): I'm as real as these double Ds. Would you like to touch?

JOHNSON: *He reaches out but grabs his own hand and stops himself.* I'm okay.

FISH (A): That's alright. Seems you've already tasted the fruits of these teats. *Motioning to caviar.*

JOHNSON: Oh, I actually haven't tried it yet.

FISH pulls chair from other table to JOHNSON's table. FISH sits.

FISH (A): Hmm, do you have reservations about my eggs?

JOHNSON: I mean these are yourC eggs right? Well, do you ever feel... upset... about giving up all your babies like that?

FISH (A): Eh, not really. *A beat.* Are you close with your family?

JOHNSON: Wow, family's really a hot topic tonight, isn't it?

FISH (A) just stares at him.

JOHNSON: Well, sometimes. Well, I don't know...

FISH (A): Come on. Who am I gonna tell? I'm just a fish, WITH BREASTS.

JOHNSON: I guess you're right. Well, I just feel like my family's growing without me. My younger sister... You don't want hear this, I'm sorry.

FISH (A): No, no. Come to mama. *Holds him in her fish breasts.*

JOHNSON: Wow these are cushy.

FISH (A): Real double Ds.

JOHNSON: Well, my sister's 4 years younger than me, and she just had her first kid, and here I am, failing to order buttered pasta off the kid's menu. Couldn't even bring myself to go to her baby shower.

CHEF (B) enters stage right.

CHEF (B): EH, YOU. GET THE FUCK BACK IN THE KITCHEN. WE'VE GOT MORE ORDERS.

CHEF (B) exits stage right.

FISH (A): Oh! Well you know what they say: A mother's job is never done.

FISH (A) begins to walk out. Stops before exiting. Turns around addressing JOHNSON.

FISH (A): Mr. Quail? She invited you, right?

JOHNSON: Who?

FISH (A): Your sister.... *Smirks.* I hope you come again.

JOHNSON. *To himself* hm.

WAITER (B) enters stage right quickly.

WAITER (B): Sir, are you enjoying your meal?

JOHNSON: I haven't really tried the caviar. Do you know when my ribs will be out?

WAITER (B): They don't come out until you've seen your entertainment portion of the meal.

JOHNSON: Entertainment?

WAITER (B): But of course. It's only the best part of the meal.

WAITER (B) flourishes hand towards stage left where PERSON A (A) enters, singing "America the Brave." WAITER (B) runs off stage right to get ready for HIBACHI CHEF. The energy here really picks up. Transitions should be quick and almost overlapping.

PERSON A (A): Oh, say can you see by the donzerlee lie. What so proudly we hailed—*sings softer as... HIBACHI speaks*

HIBACHI CHEF (B) enters stage right. PERSON A continues singing until HIBACHI CHEF (B) speaks. At that point PERSON A leaves. HIBACHI CHEF (B) is doing HIBACHI CHEF motions with two forks.

HIBACHI CHEF (B): DID YOU ORDER THE SHRIMP FRIED RICE WITH EXTRA EGG? DOESN'T MATTER. VOILA.

PERSON A (A) exits stage left.

JOHNSON: I didn't even know this place did hibachi.

HIBACHI CHEF (B): Well we do now. And by the way. Happy Birthday, Mr. Quail.

HIBACHI CHEF (B) throws off hat and smears lipstick on face. They are now MARILYN MONROE

JOHNSON: What on Earth?

MARILYN MONROE (still person B): Happy birthday to you. Happy birthday to you. Happy birthday, Mr. President.

PERSON A runs back on stage now from stage left holding the melodica. Tosses the melodica to JOHNSON.

PERSON A: MELODICA SOLO. NOW.

JOHNSON: I don't play.

PERSON A and PERSON B: *Extremely and suddenly in sync.* We know you do.

JOHNSON begins to play the melodica. PERSON A exits stage left. PERSON B exits stage right.

SELEN (A) re enters stage left (glasses on) .

SELEN (A): Did I hear Melodica?

JOHNSON: Ms. De ON?

SELEN (A): Reminds me of my days at the speakeasy. With Patti LuPone. But I knew her as Patti LuPUSSY. Me. Her. Having RELATIONS. SHIRT? Yes. SHOES? NO. TAP DANCING.

TAP DANCER (B) enters stage right, furiously tap dancing with socks on.

JOHNSON: What's going on?

MAITRE' D (A) enters stage left, holding the buttered pasta. They place it on the table.

JOHNSON: *sternly, confused and distressed.* I ordered ribs.

TAP DANCER (B) taps awkwardly a few more times and then backs out slowly as if attempting to exit the awkward moment.

MAITRE' D (A): *Condescendingly, as if talking to a child.* Johnson, you wanted buttered pasta.

JOHNSON: But I ordered ribs! *Throws chair to side.*

MAITRE' D (A) exits stage left. BARTENDER (B) suddenly pops up from behind the bar.

BARTENDER (B): *Low energy.* Are you close with your family, Johnson?

JOHNSON: Why does everyone keep asking me that?? NO. NO I'm not!

BARTENDER (B): Do you want to be close with them?

JOHNSON: *Really frantic, high energy, pacing.* Come on. I'm just a guy who doesn't have anyone to text about weird things they see at restaurants and only knows how to play mediocre melodica and and.. they wouldn't want me around.

FISH (A) reenters. Breasts as big as ever.

FISH (A): But you said she invited you?

JOHNSON: Well, I guess that's true.

BARTENDER (B) relentlessly shaking a glass as a bartender does.

BARTENDER (B): And you seem pretty close with your dad. *Holds up gin bottle.* Rustic Cavern, amiright?

JOHNSON: We get along.

FISH (A): When was the baby shower?

JOHNSON: Well, actually, tonight. I booked this dinner a while ago and thought she wouldn't care if I didn't show up, so...

FISH (A) gets up to leaves but speaks as she goes.

FISH (A): Hey look, maybe I'm just a fish with breasts and maybe I'm an absent mother. But maybe I know better. And if I weren't feeding my children to the hungry mouths of lonely men, then there'd be thousands of baby showers. And I'd want my brother at every single one of them.

FISH (A) leaves. A beat.

JOHNSON: Hmm. Maybe they... do want me there. Being an uncle? *Smiles at the thought of this.* Maybe I will go.

JOHNSON leaves, comes back, grabs buttered pasta for himself but turns to speak to the audience.

JOHNSON: I'm an adult okay. It's for the baby.

Actually leaves.

SELEN (A) : Did I hear baby??? Me. Anyone. Reproduction? Love. Fish. Tap dancing.
UNCLE!!!!

LIGHTS DOWN.